



Supervisor Attendance & Makeup **Operations Guide**

Virginia University of Integrative Medicine Effective: Spring 2026

1. Purpose and How to Use This Guide

This guide establishes standardized operational procedures for managing student attendance and makeup shifts within the East Asian Medicine (EAM) clinic. Supervisors must use this document to ensure clinical consistency, accurate record-keeping, and strict adherence to institutional policy. This guide focuses on operational execution; for formal policy language, refer to the Student and Supervisor Handbooks.

2. Core Supervisor Responsibilities

Supervisors are the primary agents of clinic accountability. Responsibilities include:

- **Accurate Attendance Entry:** Recording exact arrival times for all students in Populi.
 - **Verification:** Confirming student eligibility for makeup shifts via the Live Clinic Schedule (LCS).
 - **Documentation:** Signing Clinical Diary entries and workbooks accurately, including notations for shifts with no patients.
 - **Operational Execution:** Managing group assignments and ensuring treatment credits are only awarded for active intern roles.
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3. Recording Tardiness and Absences

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Supervisors must record the **exact arrival time** in the Populi comment field for any student who arrives after the designated start of the shift (8:30 AM or 1:30 PM).

- **1 to 30 minutes late:** Tardy
 - **30 minutes or more late:** Absence
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4. Handling 30 to 44 Minute Late Arrivals

If a student arrives between 30 and 44 minutes late:

- The student is marked **Absent** in Populi.
 - No treatment credits will be awarded for that shift.
 - If operationally permitted by the supervisor, the student may remain for the shift.
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5. Handling 45+ Minute Late Arrivals

If a student arrives 45 minutes or more after the start of the shift:

- The student is marked **Absent** in Populi.
 - The student must leave the clinic and make up the shift.
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6. Supervisor Notification of Unexpected Absence

If a student is absent past the 30-minute mark and the absence was not already reflected on the Live Clinic Schedule (LCS), and the student has not contacted the supervisor regarding the absence, the supervisor must notify the DCE Office immediately. This helps ensure timely follow-up, attendance review, and appropriate documentation of unexpected or potentially unreported absences.

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7. Makeup Approval vs. Makeup Verification

Supervisors do not approve makeup shifts. Only the DCE Office or designated clinical administration has the authority to approve makeup requests. The supervisor's role is to verify that a student has already received official approval before allowing them to join the shift.

8. How to Verify an Approved Makeup

The **Live Clinic Schedule (LCS)** is the authoritative operational source for verifying approved makeup shifts. Supervisors must check the **blue "Makeup" section** for the specific date and shift.

- Supervisors do not have independent access to student Populi confirmation forms.
 - If a student believes there is an error in the LCS, the student may show their processed Populi response or View Form result, but the student should be directed to contact the DCE Office for resolution before participating as a makeup.
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9. What to Do When a Makeup Student Arrives

1. **Verify:** Confirm the student is listed in the LCS blue section.
 2. **Coordinate:** Coordinate with reception/front desk as needed.
 3. **Assign:** Place the student in a group. Priority should be given to existing single-intern groups. If no single groups are available, the student may work in the designated Makeup Group.
 4. **Manage:** Ensure the student is actively participating in patient care or directed clinical learning.
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10. Hours, Treatment Credit, and Participation

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- **Attendance Hours:** Clinical attendance hours may be credited when the student attends the full shift, remains actively engaged as directed, and properly documents the shift in the Clinical Diary.
 - **Treatment Credit:** Awarded only for active participation in Lead Intern or Assistant Intern roles.
 - **No-Patient Scenarios:** If no patients are available, the student must remain engaged in directed clinical learning activities as assigned by the supervisor.
 - **Oversight:** Supervisors sign the Clinical Diary at the end of the shift as usual. The DCE handles the final processing of treatment-credit limits during the formal workbook review.
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11. Clinical Diary Documentation

Accurate documentation is required for every shift.

- **Signature Required:** Supervisors must sign the student's Clinical Diary at the end of every shift to confirm attendance.
 - **No Patients:** If no patients were seen during the shift, "No Patients" should be written in the diary entry.
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12. Absence Resolution and Attendance Updates

To resolve an "Absent" status in Populi:

1. The student must present their signed Clinical Diary entry from the makeup shift to their original supervisor (the supervisor of the missed shift).
2. The original supervisor verifies the makeup completion against the LCS.
3. The original supervisor updates the status in Populi from **"Absent"** to **"Excused."**

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4. The supervisor **must** enter the date the makeup was completed in the Populi comment field.
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13. School Closures and Rare Exceptions

- **Closures:** Shifts missed due to holidays, snow days, etc., must be made up. These do not count toward the "one excused absence per course, per quarter" allowance.
 - **Incomplete Grades:** This is a rare exception for documented emergencies. Incomplete should not be relied upon for normal scheduling or routine absences. Questions about Incomplete eligibility should be referred to the DCE Office.
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14. Common Supervisor Errors and Wrong Assumptions

- **Unauthorized Approval:** Verbally granting a student a makeup shift without DCE approval.
 - **Inaccurate Entry:** Recording school closures or snow days as "Present" instead of "Absent."
 - **Processing Errors:** Marking a completed makeup shift as "Present" instead of "Excused" in the original record.
 - **Missing Data:** Marking a shift "Excused" without entering the makeup completion date in the Populi comment field.
 - **Missing Escalation:** Failing to notify the DCE Office when a student is unexpectedly absent past the 30-minute mark without prior notice or LCS indication.
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15. Key Takeaways

- Record the **exact arrival time** for every student who is not on time.
 - **30 to 44 minutes late** results in an Absence and loss of treatment credits.
 - **45+ minutes late** results in an Absence and the student must leave the clinic.
 - The **LCS blue section** is the only authoritative source for makeup verification.
 - Supervisors **verify** — they do not approve.
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16. Disclaimer

This guide serves as an operational supplement. The VUIM Student Clinic Handbook and Supervisor Handbook remain the formal authorities on all institutional policies. In the event of a conflict between this guide and the Handbooks (as updated by official University memos), the Handbooks shall govern.

Questions? Contact the DCE Office: dce@vuim.edu

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